

THE MOVE

Good to see you. No rush - how has the day landed so far? -> I'm glad we get a minute properly. What's been taking most of your attention? -> Before I jump into my bit, how are you seeing it? -> No pressure to go deep, but I'm curious what ?

START HERE

Slow down, orient to them, and make one low-pressure warm comment before your question or point.

SAY THIS

Openers	"Good to see you."
Low-pressure warmth	"No rush - take your time."
Warm attention	"That makes sense."
Professional / leader...	"Before I give my view, how are you seeing it?"
High-status or busy...	"I'll keep this tight."
Dating / social	"No pressure, but I'm curious about that."

AVOID

- The situation needs immediate directness, safety action, or a firm boundary before rapport.
- Warmth is becoming approval-seeking, flattery, over-smiling, or excessive accommodation.
- You are using warmth to hide an agenda or soften pressure rather than preserve real choice.

REMEMBER

Warmth is safety, not friendliness.